MONTHLY UPDATE

Angola: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-24 · 44 systems and instruments tracked, 7 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-24 — July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

A nine-day national mobile outage from 28 July dominated the month and tested an architecture that has decrees but no law. The incumbent's network went down at 02:20 and the mobile layer was restored gradually to 30 July, but the operator dates the return of every service carried over it to 5 August; the state had settled the sale of 15% of that operator the day before. The kwanza entered the regional settlement system on 27 July.

The law arrived at the end of the month: the National Assembly adopted the cybersecurity bill on 12 August, which is not yet promulgated and which the opposition and part of civil society object to over its data-access provisions a year before the presidential election. Two days later the President authorised US$28m and opened tender for a national digital identity and electronic signatures platform sized for 30 million identities.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

On 23 July a state-owned telecoms arm commercially launched an enterprise fifth-generation service in Cabinda at about US$20m, with a stated ambition of every provincial capital by 2027 — the operator's own figures.

Data Storage

The commercial data centre is operating at up to 3 MW and more than 800 racks over 19,000 square metres on US$30m, near the cable landings, with a plan to exceed 7 MW within five years. Its group contracted six times as much power in the first half of 2026 as a year earlier — a group figure, not an Angolan one.

Cybersecurity

The incumbent operator's mobile voice, data and internet services failed nationwide from 02:20 on 28 July, affecting more than twenty million customers; fixed fibre and fixed-wireless stayed up throughout, so the failure was confined to the mobile layer. The network itself came back over four days — localised from 11:45 on 29 July, full second- and third-generation national coverage at about 23:00 on 30 July, and messaging and electronic airtime sales back on 31 July. The services running on it took nine: the operator dates voice, messaging, mobile data, internet access and the third-party services carried over its network to 5 August, and gives the same close in its own market update. Four days in, card terminals were unreliable in Luanda shops and at filling stations and citizens were queueing at the ATMs for cash; a week in, the cardless payment app was still unusable and Luanda bank branches were queueing one to two hours. No attribution, access vector or scope of data loss is established.

The aftermath produced the first public pressure for rules rather than repair: customers and security practitioners called for mandatory incident-reporting obligations and a national computer security incident response team, small businesses describing lost sales and failed card payments across the disruption. Angola has neither: the base holds no CSIRT and no reporting duty, and the critical national infrastructure designation that would carry one is itself *Not held*.

The Executive's first answer to the National Assembly on critical-infrastructure risk, given on 31 July, was the standing build programme — the national data centre and the country-code domain — with no new measure, obligation or timetable announced. Telecommunications remains undesignated as critical national infrastructure, and named analysts argued during the month that it should be designated alongside power and water.

A regional preparatory meeting on radiocommunications opened in Luanda on 3 August, seven days into the outage and two before it closed, with the resilience of telecommunications infrastructure on its agenda.

Check Point Research's July telemetry puts Angolan organisations at 5,714 attacks a week against an African average of 3,237, the highest of the four African markets it broke out — the vendor's installed base, not a national measurement.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

A logistics regulator communiqué of 27 July described a single window absorbing three separate agency platforms, framed explicitly as a formalisation and tax-base instrument.

Digital Identity and CRVS

On 28 July the justice ministry launched an at-home service priced at Kz 250,000 for processing and Kz 10,000 for delivery alone, in one province only, the minister justifying the fee as a product of exclusivity.

The single digital identity, named as a workstream since 2024 and as a component of the US$150m public digital infrastructure contract in June, acquired a price and a procurement. Despacho Presidencial 300/26 of 13 August authorised US$28m and opened the public tender for a National Digital Identity and Electronic Signatures Platform, specified to support up to 30 million digital identities and to let citizens, firms and public officials use one digital credential for public services, digital contracts, electronic verification of customers and legally valid electronic signatures. No supplier, timetable, or relationship to the earlier contract is stated.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Two payment milestones fell within a fortnight. The central bank completed migration of domestic payments to the international messaging standard on 10 July across the switch, the exchange and the real-time settlement participants. And on 27 July the kwanza was formally introduced into the regional real-time settlement system — the second currency added since that system launched in 2013 — against 2025 trade and interbank flows with the other fourteen member states of about US$3.77bn across nine currencies.

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

Identity delivery moved on the printing side. From 1 July all 21 provinces print the identity card locally, ending centralisation at a single production centre, with two to three printers per province planned and a 24-to-48-hour issuance target; one province reports issuance under 24 hours against one to two weeks before June. Against that, more than 120,000 issued cards were awaiting collection nationwide as at 15 July, prompting a civic campaign enlisting churches and traditional authorities.

A single social register was launched in the week ending 25 July with no enrolment target, data-protection basis or governing instrument stated.

The electoral register, updating since 15 June against a universe of 16.7 million citizens, acquired its first national enrolment figure in August and it came from the opposition rather than the administration. Four parties put the count above 730,000 and demanded an independent audit of the electoral database, alleging administrative discretion, uneven deployment of registration brigades and recurring biometric-system failures, and said the administration refuses to release enrolment statistics disaggregated by province, municipality and commune. At provincial level the Lunda-Norte government reported over 40,000 residents updated and pressed mining-sector workers to register through the one-stop service desks. None of the allegations has been adjudicated, and because no official series exists there is nothing to test them against - which is itself the complaint.

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

The education ministry and a domestic technology firm expanded their work on the integrity of the national education database under a five-year, thirty-country data challenge, with the ministry's planning office as counterpart. No data-quality baseline, scope or completion date is published, and no contract or programme document is held.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The government-systems movement in the window is a procurement decision rather than a build. The executive authorised an integrated digital transformation programme for the public finances by presidential order, as a direct award, covering modernisation of finance ministry services and a restructuring of state bodies and framed as raising revenue collection and cutting bureaucracy. What a direct award removes is the part of the record a reader could check: the supplier, the scope document and the delivery schedule are all unpublished, so the programme enters the ledger as an intention with a price attached and nothing behind it. Against that, the one government system already in service produced its first operating figures: the tax authority reported on 23 August that 51,245 large taxpayers and state suppliers had joined electronic invoicing since November 2025, issuing 36,341,801 invoices at a daily run-rate near 400,000 and peaking around 700,000, through 255 automatically certified software packages. The figures are the collector's own and the mandate reaches general and simplified-regime taxpayers only in 2027, so this is the compliant half of the base rather than the base.

National statistics

The statistics office launched a census portal and a mobile application on 2 July, both built by its own technical staff, carrying census indicators by geographic level and macroeconomic series; no open-data licence, bulk download or programming interface is stated.

Use of satellite data

The regulator licensed a first private reseller of national satellite capacity on 2 July, following 37 firms entering the commercial process by April.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

The cybersecurity bill re-entered detailed consideration. Three specialised committees met jointly on 3 August and voted it chapter by chapter on three axes — drafting, systematisation and harmonisation — all presented as preserving the substance approved in generality in January 2026 on 105 votes for, one against and 75 abstentions. Deputies had suspended the same discussion on 7 and 8 July over drafting non-conformities in the preamble and first two chapters, one party warning that a redraft that deep might require a wholly new bill.

Five days before that vote, the country's own delegation told a regional forum in Lusaka on 29 July that its cybersecurity law was still in a diagnostic phase. Both statements are the government's own.

The bill then passed. The National Assembly adopted it on 12 August by 104 votes to 56, the governing party for and the opposition against with no abstentions, on a text of presidential initiative directed at protecting networks, critical infrastructure and essential services through prevention, detection, incident response and restoration. The penalties are administrative and graduated: seven to 70 minimum wages for individuals on the lightest infringements, rising to 500 for individuals and 4,000 for legal persons on the most serious. No promulgation, gazette number or entry-into-force date is on file.

What the vote settles and what it leaves open are different things. The law requires telecommunications operators to transmit any communication whose content is criminal or prejudicial to state security, and the opposition and part of civil society object that neither the qualifying content nor the circumstances in which a subscriber's personal data reaches the authorities is defined — a lawyer quoted in the same account gives the circulation of a call to demonstrate as an example that might qualify. The vote came a year before the presidential election, days after the online-falsehoods law entered into force, and weeks after the cyberattack on the incumbent operator that the governing party cited for it.

The National Assembly approved legislative authorisation 166 votes to nil on 30 July for the President to legislate an electronic-signature and digital-certification regime, valid 90 days after publication of the enabling law — so the regime defining an accrediting authority, a root certification entity and the evidential weight of a signature will be an executive instrument, grounded on the insufficiency of two 2011 texts.

The national cybersecurity centre, whose statute was published in December 2025, is still described in the future tense by the minister responsible: on 10 August he said it would be launched during 2026 to monitor digital threats, defend critical infrastructure and coordinate incident response.

Data protection

The data protection law is in force and unamended, and its exemptions are wider than its penalties. Fines run from USD 75,000 to 150,000, trebled for legal persons and cumulated across concurrent contraventions, but the statute substitutes a law or decree for the regulator's authorisation in two places, and puts processing under state-secrecy, state-security and judicial-secrecy rules outside the law altogether. The state can therefore authorise itself, and the categories where it most often processes are excluded at the outset.

A report published on 15 August by the South African organisation Intelwatch found the intelligence service SINSE reaching biometric data without judicial supervision, and identified no rule stating when it may obtain identity, biometric or mobility data and no independent body to review such requests; the migration service confirmed at the Santa Clara border post that SINSE may request access under established protocols. The same report puts the national biometric border-control system at US$112m, awarded in February 2025 to Dolinveste Lda with Poland's Technology for Business, reportedly by direct award rather than open tender, and adds a EUR 130m passport and biometric identity contract with Hungary's ANY Security Printing, taking the total past US$250m without significant tender, parliamentary scrutiny or human-rights impact assessment. Against that spending it records no biometric system operating at the border posts with the Democratic Republic of the Congo, crossings there regulated by a manually checked seven-day paper pass, and the one functional post reading passports against the migration database but with fingerprint and height capture discontinued on maintenance grounds. It also records that the electoral register is derived from the civil identity database, with the voter card to be used for the last time in 2027 before the identity card becomes the sole registration credential under the 2025 official-registration law, and that the register has never had a comprehensive independent technical audit. The figures and the characterisation of the awards are Intelwatch's; no procurement record is on file.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

At a trade fair on 22 July the second operator launched the web version of a subscription artificial-intelligence assistant at Kz 300 a month, replacing a text-message version, pitched at student research; no usage figure or model provenance is published.

The country's permanent representative to the United Nations argued on 31 July that persistent digital disparity keeps developing states out of artificial-intelligence rule-setting, and backed three international governance processes. That is a stated position rather than an instrument.

ICT Industry

The month's technology events were financial and commercial rather than industrial. The state raised Kz 300.3bn selling 15% of the incumbent operator, reported as about US$329m, at 120.72% subscription with 16,571 of 17,549 orders filled and 11,264 new shareholders; settlement fell on 28 July, the day the same operator's network went down.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

Satellite-based inclusion produced two counts eight days apart on different bases: 20,000 students across six universities and more than 300 localities on 13 July, and 3,972 students at two Luanda schools connected by satellite and white-space on 14 July.

Access to services

Financial inclusion was scored at 51.7% for the first quarter of 2026 against a 65% target for 2027 on 9 July, with banking at about 32% or 5.7 million people and mobile and digital payments up about 56% year on year; the strategy document itself is not held.

Literacy

School computing continued to be delivered by installation count. The telecommunications minister inaugurated a 25-computer laboratory serving 3,051 students at a polytechnic and said the programme behind it had by then installed more than 2,000 computers across 88 schools nationwide. Both figures are the ministry's own, and the machines-to-students ratio at the one site it named is the part of the programme a national total cannot show. No budget, connectivity provision or maintenance arrangement is published.

Finance

New investments

The digital acceleration project acquired published targets for the first time. At its third steering committee on 30 July it was stated to be contracted to reach ten million people by March 2030, lifting broadband users from a stated baseline of 14,743,807 to 19.7 million and getting 400 firms onto green digital products, on US$300m of financing whose terms are a market-rate loan rather than concessional finance.

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